

Digital Download: 4
Who to Follow in the
Identity Industry

Who to Follow in the Identity Industry

Companion Digital Download — Identity and Access Management
Exam Prep Guide
Abbas Kudrati

Introduction

Identity and access management has a strong professional community — practitioners, researchers, analysts, standards architects, and evangelists who share what they know, push back on bad ideas, and move the industry forward. Keeping up with these people is one of the most practical things you can do to stay current on emerging threats, evolving standards, and how identity actually works in production.

This appendix lists forty-nine identity professionals worth following, in alphabetical order by first name. The list draws from multiple sources: the NHI Management Group's Top 20 Identity Evangelists (nhimg.org), the IDPro community, KuppingerCole and Gartner analyst networks, The Identity Underground, the Identity Management Institute, podcast hosts, and practitioners who consistently contribute through writing, speaking, and open-source work.

Each entry includes a short introduction and a profile link. Follow them, engage with what they publish, and start contributing your own perspective — that is how you become part of the community rather than just an observer.

Note: This list was curated at the time of publication and reflects a cross-section of the global identity community. Plenty of other outstanding professionals contribute to this field every day. If you are not on this list, keep sharing your work — the identity community gets stronger with every new voice.

Top 50 Identity Professionals and Thought Leaders

Listed in alphabetical order by first name.

#	Name	Introduction	Profile / Link
1	Abbas Kudrati	Field CISO for Asia Pacific, China and Japan (APCJ) at F5. Former Microsoft Asia Chief Cybersecurity Advisor, best-selling author, Professor of Practice at La Trobe University, and global keynote speaker on Zero Trust and identity security.	linkedin.com/in/akudrati

2	Alexandre Blanc	Cybersecurity leader focused on threat intelligence, risk management, and enterprise defence. Known for promoting practical, people-centred security transformation across the global cyber community.	linkedin.com/in/alexandre-blanc-cyber-security
3	Alexei Balaganski	Industry analyst covering cybersecurity and AI applications. His work spans database protection through to AI-based automation, drawing on both development and infosec experience.	linkedin.com/in/balaganski
4	Andras Cser	Industry analyst covering IAM, fraud management, privileged identity, and entitlement management. One of the most cited analyst voices on access governance and identity modernisation.	linkedin.com/in/andrascser
5	André Koot	Independent IAM consultant and prolific IDPro Body of Knowledge contributor. Decades of enterprise IAM experience with particular depth in access control, non-human account management, and identity governance.	linkedin.com/in/andre-koot
6	Andrew Hindle	Digital identity community builder and event organiser, best known for his involvement with the Internet Identity Workshop and Identiverse. Has done more than most to foster collaboration across the identity ecosystem.	linkedin.com/in/ahindle
7	Anujh Tewari	Cybersecurity advisor and CISO-level practitioner across India and South Asia, with a background spanning global enterprise security leadership and cybersecurity services delivery. Passionate about the transformative power of AI in cybersecurity and a recognised voice on digital trust across the Asia-Pacific region.	linkedin.com/in/anujhtewari
8	Atul Tulshibagwale	Co-creator of the Shared Signals Framework (SSF) and Continuous Access Evaluation Profile (CAEP). Leads the effort to enable real-time security event sharing between identity providers and relying parties.	linkedin.com/in/tulshi
9	Chase Cunningham (Dr.)	Known as “Dr. Zero Trust.” Cybersecurity strategist and author whose work has shaped Zero Trust adoption globally. Brings military intelligence experience to enterprise cybersecurity.	linkedin.com/in/dr-chase-cunningham
10	Confidence Staveley	Cybersecurity awareness and education leader working to empower African communities through the CyberSafe Foundation. Among Africa’s most influential voices in global cybersecurity advocacy and digital literacy.	linkedin.com/in/confidencestaveley

11	David Lee	IAM thought leader, strategist, and host of the Identity Jedi podcast. Excels at connecting the technical and human sides of identity in ways that business leaders can actually use.	linkedin.com/in/identityjedi
12	David Mahdi	Digital trust strategist and former Gartner analyst working at the intersection of identity, security, and risk. Prominent voice on digital trust ecosystems, cryptography, and identity verification.	linkedin.com/in/dmahdi
13	Dean H. Saxe	IDPro founding member with deep expertise in account recovery, FIDO/passkey authentication, and identity resilience. IDPro Body of Knowledge contributor.	linkedin.com/in/deanhaxe
14	Erik Wahlström	Industry analyst covering IAM, access control, PKI, identity fabrics, and machine identity. Known for making complex identity architecture accessible to enterprise decision-makers.	linkedin.com/in/erik-wahlström
15	Espen Bago	Original founder of “IdentiBeer” and identity strategist. Author of “Words of Identity,” a guide to untangling IAM terminology. Works at the intersection of technical, policy, and linguistic clarity within IAM.	linkedin.com/in/iamsolutions
16	Eve Maler	Global leader in digital identity, consent, and privacy technology. Co-invented SAML and contributed to OAuth and User-Managed Access (UMA). Long-time advocate for human-centred, interoperable identity.	linkedin.com/in/evemaler
17	Felix Gaehtgens	Former senior analyst at Gartner and KuppingerCole with deep coverage of IAM, PAM, machine identity, and security architecture. Has a track record of turning complex identity problems into enterprise-ready guidance.	linkedin.com/in/felixgaehtgens
18	Francis Odum	Cybersecurity researcher and independent analyst, founder of Software Analyst Cybersecurity Research. Covers identity, cloud, and application security, and teaches cybersecurity.	linkedin.com/in/francis-odum
19	Graham Williamson	Senior IAM consultant and co-author of multiple IDPro Body of Knowledge articles on digital identity lifecycle, non-human identities, and workforce planning. One of the foundational voices in IAM education.	linkedin.com/in/graham-williamson-iamguru

20	Heather Flanagan	Federation and trust framework expert with deep roots in standards and community governance. Has led identity initiatives through REFEDS, IETF, and other global trust communities.	linkedin.com/in/hlflanagan
21	Heiko Klarl	Identity and cybersecurity marketing strategist, formerly CMO at iC Consult. Helped shape the public voice of identity consulting and has long championed awareness of identity's role in digital transformation.	linkedin.com/in/heiko-klarl
22	Helen Yu	Cybersecurity and digital transformation strategist focused on aligning business growth with security resilience. Speaker, author, and advisor helping leaders treat security as a business driver rather than a cost centre.	linkedin.com/in/yuhelenyu
23	Henrique Teixeira	Influential IAM strategist with a strong track record in CIAM and Zero Trust. Former Gartner analyst who combines analytical rigour with practical deployment experience for perimeterless identity strategies.	linkedin.com/in/bernardes
24	Henry Bagdasarian	Founder of the Identity Management Institute (IMI) and creator of CIAM, CIGE, CIMP, and other IMI certifications. Author of "Identity Diet" and a long-standing voice in identity governance education.	linkedin.com/in/identitymate
25	Ian Glazer	Identity standards pioneer and co-founder of IDPro. Former SVP of Identity Product Management at Salesforce. Has consistently pushed for ethical, interoperable, and privacy-respecting identity systems.	linkedin.com/in/iglazer
26	Jeff Steadman	Co-host of the Identity at the Center (IDAC) podcast, covering digital identity, IAM, and cybersecurity. Brings together identity, cloud, and risk perspectives for practitioners and leaders.	linkedin.com/in/jeffsteadman
27	Jesse Minor	Identity governance and risk management professional focused on practical strategies for secure access and compliance. Known for emphasising measurable outcomes and resilient identity architectures.	linkedin.com/in/jesse-minor
28	Jim McDonald	Co-host of the Identity at the Center (IDAC) podcast. Decades of hands-on IAM experience, with a talent for making complex identity and access problems understandable in business terms.	linkedin.com/in/jimmcdonaldpmp

29	Justin Richer	Security architect and software engineer, active in IETF standards work including the WIMSE working group on workload identity. Contributor to OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect, G NAP, and HTTP Message Signatures standards.	linkedin.com/in/justinricher
30	Lalit Choda	Known as “Mr. NHI.” Founder of the Non-Human Identity Management Group (nhimg.org). The leading evangelist on NHI risks, author of groundbreaking NHI research, and keynote speaker on non-human identity security.	linkedin.com/in/lalit-choda
31	Lance Peterman	IAM and cybersecurity expert spanning risk management, cloud security, and mobility. Teaches identity at university level and is a regular presence at Identiverse and RSA Conference.	linkedin.com/in/lancepeterman
32	Malhar Vora	PAM engineering specialist with deep expertise in privileged access, cloud IAM, and identity resilience. Conference speaker at AISA and EIC, and an Identity Underground member.	linkedin.com/in/voramalhar
33	Mark Morowczynski	Long-standing voice in the Microsoft identity community and co-founder of the AskPFEPlat blog. Speaks at Black Hat, DEF CON, and Ignite on Entra ID and enterprise identity deployment.	linkedin.com/in/markmorow
34	Martin Kuppinger	Founder of KuppingerCole Analysts. Author of 50+ IT books and one of the top global voices in identity management and digital trust.	linkedin.com/in/martinkuppinger
35	Martin Sandren	Experienced IAM architect and consultant who helps global enterprises build scalable, standards-based identity platforms. Particularly strong on SSO, federation, and access control.	linkedin.com/in/martinsandren
36	Matthias Reinwarth	Senior IAM analyst, moderator, and podcast host. Does valuable work connecting the identity community through research, interviews, and events.	linkedin.com/in/matthias-reinwarth
37	Merill Fernando	Microsoft identity community builder and creator of some of the most widely used tools in the Entra ecosystem, including Maester.dev, cmd.ms, Graph X-Ray, and idPowerToys. Host of the Entra.Chat podcast and author of the Entra.News newsletter read weekly by many thousands of identity professionals. An indispensable resource for anyone working with Microsoft identity.	linkedin.com/in/merill

38	Mike Kiser	Identity strategist focused on identity governance, privacy, and ethical technology. Frequent speaker at major security conferences and active in standards work.	linkedin.com/in/mike-kiser
39	Mike Schwartz	Host of Identifierati Office Hours and founder of Gluu, an open-source IAM platform. A long-time OAuth and OpenID Connect advocate who has done a great deal to make enterprise-grade IAM accessible.	linkedin.com/in/nynymike
40	Nishant Kaushik	Identity product leader with a long track record in IAM innovation and a prolific inventor with multiple patents. Has served on advisory boards for Identiverse and RSA Conference.	linkedin.com/in/nishantkaushik
41	Pamela Dingle	Identity standards leader whose work spans OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect, FIDO, and SCIM. Founding member of Women in Identity and a strong advocate for open collaboration in standards.	linkedin.com/in/pameladingle
42	Philip Hoyer	IAM expert and security industry veteran focused on passwordless authentication, phishing-resistant MFA, and regulatory compliance. Regular speaker at cybersecurity leadership events.	linkedin.com/in/philiphoyer
43	Pieter Kasselmann	Active in IETF standards work on securing machine identities across multi-cloud environments, including the WIMSE working group. Deep expertise in SPIFFE, OAuth, and workload identity standards.	linkedin.com/in/pieter-kasselmann
44	Rebecca (Becky) Archambault	Identity leader in the healthcare sector, defining identity strategies across workforce, consumer, and partner ecosystems. Has chaired the H-ISAC Identity Committee and founded the WNY Identities Working Group.	linkedin.com/in/rebecca-archambault
45	Sean Deuby	Identity and directory services expert with long experience in enterprise and hybrid identity. Microsoft MVP and author. Particularly well-known for Active Directory and identity resilience work.	linkedin.com/in/seandeuby
46	Sebastian Rohr	Known as the “IdentiBeer Guy.” IAM and compliance expert recognised for combining deep technical knowledge with business acumen. Helps enterprises align identity, governance, and regulatory frameworks.	linkedin.com/in/sebastianrohr

47	Simon Moffatt	IAM innovator, author, and founder of The Cyber Hut. Provides practical research and advisory covering identity security, governance, and Zero Trust adoption.	linkedin.com/in/simonmoffatt
48	Steve Wilson	Founder of the Lockstep Group. Australian-based digital identity and privacy expert, shaping identity strategy across APAC.	linkedin.com/in/lockstep
49	Steven Rennick	Veteran IT and identity professional whose career spans desktop support through to enterprise architecture. Focuses on NHI, authentication/authorisation, and Zero Trust. Identity Underground member.	linkedin.com/in/steven-rennick

50# In memoriam: Vittorio Bertocci

A legendary identity architect whose work at Auth0, Okta and Microsoft shaped how a generation of developers understands identity. He co-authored RFC 9470 (OAuth 2.0 Step Up Authentication Challenge Protocol) and created the Identity, Unlocked podcast. His educational contributions permanently raised the bar for the entire identity industry, and the community is poorer for his absence.

auth0.com/blog/in-celebration-of-vittorio-bertocci

Key Communities, Podcasts, and Platforms to Follow

Beyond individual thought leaders, the following communities and platforms are essential for anyone building a career in identity:

Identity Communities and Resources

Resource	Description	URL
IDPro	The professional association for digital identity practitioners. Publishes the Body of Knowledge (BoK) that underpins the CIDPRO™ certification.	idpro.org
The Identity Underground	Exclusive global network of CXOs and practitioners focused on identity security innovation.	theidentityunderground.com
NHI Management Group	The leading research and advisory group on non-human identity risks, founded by Lalit Choda. Offers NHI Foundation training.	nhimg.org
Identity at the Centre Podcast	Hosted by Jeff Steadman and Jim McDonald. Covers digital identity, IAM, cloud, and cybersecurity through conversations with industry leaders.	identityatthecenter.com
Identity Jedi Podcast	Hosted by David Lee. Engaging discussions on identity, access, trust, and the human side of IAM.	identityjedi.com
Entra.Chat Podcast	Hosted by Merrill Fernando. Weekly podcast delivering practical insights on Microsoft Entra for identity administrators and security professionals.	entra.news
Identerati Office Hours	Hosted by Mike Schwartz. Live show on identity standards, open source, and where IAM is heading.	gluu.org
Women in Identity	Global non-profit promoting diversity and inclusion in the identity industry. Networking, mentoring, and events for identity professionals.	womeninidentity.org
Identity Management Institute	Professional body offering identity certifications (CIAM, CAMS, CIGE, CIMP, CIST, CIPA, CRFS, CDP, CMSC). Founded by Henry Bagdasarian.	identitymanagementinstitute.org
KuppingerCole Events	European Identity Conference (EIC), Cyberevolution, and Identity Fabric Impact Day. Premier events for identity professionals globally.	kuppingercole.com/events
Identiverse Conference	The identity industry's flagship annual conference, bringing together practitioners, vendors, and standards architects.	identiverse.com
FIDO Alliance	The industry consortium behind FIDO2, WebAuthn, and passkey standards for passwordless authentication.	fidoalliance.org

Cloud Security Alliance (CSA)	Leading organisation for cloud security best practices, research, and certifications, including CCSK. Runs active IAM working groups.	cloudsecurityalliance.org
-------------------------------	---	---------------------------

Building Your Brand

The identity community is open and welcoming. Start by engaging with content from the professionals listed above, sharing your own experiences on LinkedIn, contributing to open-source projects, attending conferences (many offer virtual access), and considering writing for the IDPro Body of Knowledge.

Your perspective matters — and the more voices in the conversation, the better the profession becomes.

Download all companion resources at: https://github.com/akudrati/CIDPRO_Book

